

Understanding Care Fees & Funding

Who pays for care, and the support that may be available — explained in plain English.

How care is paid for in the UK depends mainly on your savings, income and care needs. Here are the main routes, so you know what questions to ask.

1. Self-funding

If your capital (savings, investments and usually property) is above the upper threshold set by the government, you will normally pay your own fees. Self-funders can choose any home that meets their needs.

2. Local authority funding

If your capital is below the threshold, your local council may contribute. They carry out two assessments:

- **A needs assessment** — what care and support you require.
- **A financial assessment (means test)** — what you can afford to contribute.

Your home is usually **not** counted while you or a partner still lives there, and there is a 12-week property disregard when someone first moves into a care home permanently.

3. NHS funding

- **NHS Continuing Healthcare** — if care needs are primarily health-related, the NHS may fund the full cost. It is free and not means-tested.
- **NHS-funded Nursing Care** — a contribution towards the nursing element of fees in a nursing home.

4. Other things to ask about

- **Deferred Payment Agreement** — a council scheme letting you delay paying from your property until later.
- **Attendance Allowance** — a non-means-tested benefit for people over State Pension age who need help with personal care.
- **What the weekly fee includes** — accommodation, meals, care, activities; and what costs extra (e.g. hairdressing, chiropody).

Where to get free, independent advice

- Your local council's adult social care team
- Age UK — ageuk.org.uk
- Citizens Advice — citizensadvice.org.uk
- A specialist care-fees financial adviser (look for SOLLA accreditation)

This guide is general information and not financial advice; thresholds and rules change, so please check current figures. For a clear, itemised quote for any of our homes, call **Venza Care UK on 0800 470 1925** (Mon–Sun, 8am–8pm).